

Element J: Documentation of External Evaluation

Project Title: MJ's LAST Stand (Echo Rack)

Explain how your stakeholders evaluated your project. Describe their feedback and suggestions for improvement in detail.

All of the design requirements were completed by us, and Mr. Waller didn't have much to say about that. Overall his initial impressions were really good and he was pleasantly surprised by what we brought him. (which was the goal) He didn't really have anything bad to say about it, and no real improvements. However, he was not our only stakeholder. Technically, the entire percussion section were our stakeholders as well. Again, overall impressions were very positive, although they didn't seem to pay that much attention to it as I'd hoped. Many of the juniors recognized that this was a community project, and were impressed with the final product compared to what they had built for their project.

The real improvement area came to the actual muting process itself. The foot pedal is not the greatest and moves a lot when you try to press it, which makes it a lot harder to use. Additionally, the string needs to be fine tuned to how much it actually needs to mute the gong by. However, this would have taken a lot more time than we actually had. This can be done very easily towards the end of the year after our final concert, when we pretty much don't do anything until we throw a big party and say bye to each other until we see everyone next year. (there's a lot of free time) Some of the kids saw the wood warping issue and tried to offer solutions, to which I said absolutely not because I'm tired of dealing with it. (Half true, I didn't deny any solutions, but I never plan on actually doing anything about it unless it gets worse) Some of the freshmen also suggested using metal for better support? I don't think they realize that it kinda defeats the purpose of making it out of wood to just use metal in the end anyway.

Explain how an external field expert evaluated your project. Describe their feedback and suggestions for improvement in detail. Be sure to note how each person who provided you with feedback is qualified to do so.

As previously mentioned Mr. Szczepanski is a professional woodworker and furniture maker with his own successful business with 10+ years of experience. Although he could not come out physically to view our project, with various photos and videos he still had some ideas for improvements. Unfortunately, none of them are really any new ideas, because most of them were already mentioned in the previous section by other percussion members. This includes the wobbly foot pedal and the string adjustments. However, what Mr. Szczepanski specialized in his woodworking knowledge, where he was still overall impressed with the final result. His only woodworking improvement ideas would be to just buy a brand new piece of wood, re-stain it, and then replace it with the current warped one. He did also say that it would be a lot of work and that realistically, from a distance, the gong stand still looks fine.